

Answer key & lesson script

A2 reading · 12 focus items from Band II, Core I, Group 01

80-minute lesson: opening 5; vocabulary 12; shared reading 12; worksheet 18; discussion 15; picture breaks and idiom 5; writing 10; exit ticket 3.

Teaching focus: Amir gets repeated chances to participate. He still makes mistakes, and the team loses. Discuss belonging and practical support without making inclusion depend on sporting success.

1. It begins at the morning break, beside the school football pitch.
2. The boys keep passing the ball around Amir. He raises his hand twice, but the ball goes somewhere else.
3. His team is one goal behind. He takes the game seriously and wants to win.
4. Amir kicks too quickly and sends the ball to the other team by mistake.
5. He asks Amir to stay, suggests a short pass, stands near him, and explains where to stand. Any two are acceptable.
6. At first, Dan shouts at Noam for passing to Amir. Later, when Amir misses another pass, Dan encourages him: "Try again!"
7. He seems more confident that he belongs. He runs toward his classmates and asks which team he is on, rather than waiting beside the pitch.
8. Example: A classmate can join our game even if he is still learning. He may pass to the wrong team by mistake. We can give a short explanation and try again, as Noam does. Passing to him again helps him take part.

Accept alternatives: assess text evidence and clear meaning. For question 8, check the practical action, one relevant story detail, and three focus words. Do not require the sample wording.

Visual riddle: At sixes and sevens = confused or disorganized. The cat numbers are a visual wordplay clue, not an explanation of the idiom's historical origin.

Sources: original classroom story; exact vocabulary examples from the existing Grade 8 opening deck. **Idiom meaning:** Cambridge Dictionary.